

Startup:

A **startup** is a newly created business that aims to solve a problem with a **new or better product/service** and has the potential to **grow rapidly**.

A startup is not simply any new business.

For example:

- Opening a local grocery store → **Small business**
- Building an app that connects thousands of grocery stores with customers → **Potential startup**

The key characteristics of a startup are:

1. **Problem** – It solves a real problem.
2. **Innovation** – It offers a new or improved solution.
3. **Customers** – People are willing to use or pay for it.
4. **Scalability** – It can grow to serve many more users without costs increasing at the same rate.
5. **Business Model** – It has a way to generate revenue.
6. **Growth Potential** – It aims to grow significantly.

Simple Example

Suppose university students have difficulty finding affordable tutors.

You create an app:

Tutor-Connect → Students find verified tutors, book sessions, and pay online.

You start with 100 students at one university. If you can expand to 100 universities, the business becomes highly scalable.

That's a **startup model**.

Startup vs Traditional Business

Feature	Startup	Traditional Business
Main goal	Rapid growth	Sustainable income
Innovation	Usually high	May be low/moderate
Scalability	Very important	Not always necessary
Technology	Often important	Not always
Funding	May seek investors	Often self-funded/loans
Example	Software platform	Local restaurant
Market	Often large/global	Often local/regional

A startup can eventually become a large company. For example, companies such as Airbnb and Uber began as startup ventures and grew into major global businesses.

How to Start a Startup Business

Here's a practical roadmap.

Step 1: Find a Real Problem

Don't start with:

"I want to make an app."

Start with:

"What problem do people have that I can solve?"

For example:

Problem: University teachers spend a lot of time manually calculating CLO/PLO assessment data.

Possible solution: An AI-powered assessment management system that reads marks from answer sheets and automatically maps them to CLO/PLO outcomes.

This is much stronger than simply saying:

"I want to create an AI app."

Step 2: Identify Your Target Customers

Ask:

- Who has this problem?
- How many people have this problem?
- How frequently do they face it?
- Are they willing to pay for a solution?

For your AI assessment idea, potential customers could be:

- Universities
 - Departments
 - Teachers
 - Accreditation teams
 - Academic administrators
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Step 3: Research the Market

Find out:

- Who are your competitors?
- What solutions already exist?
- What do customers dislike about existing solutions?

- What makes your solution different?

You don't necessarily need to invent something completely new.

You can also succeed by making an existing solution:

- Cheaper
 - Faster
 - Easier
 - More reliable
 - More localized
 - Better designed
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Step 4: Define Your Business Model

You need to decide:

How will the startup make money?

Common models include:

Subscription

Customers pay monthly/yearly.

Example:

University pays \$500/year to use your assessment platform.

Commission

You take a percentage from every transaction.

Example:

A tutoring platform takes 10% from each tutoring session.

Freemium

Basic version is free; advanced features are paid.

Advertisement

Users use the service for free while businesses pay to advertise.

B2B Licensing

Businesses pay to use your software.

Step 5: Build an MVP

MVP = **Minimum Viable Product**

It is the simplest working version of your product.

For example, instead of building a complete AI assessment platform with 50 features, your first version could do only:

1. Teacher login
2. Upload scanned answer sheet
3. OCR reads student ID
4. OCR detects marks
5. Teacher verifies extracted data
6. System stores results
7. Generate CLO/PLO report

That's your MVP.

Step 6: Test With Real Users

Give your MVP to a small number of users.

For example:

3 teachers → 1 department → 1 university

Ask:

- Is it useful?
- What problems did they face?
- What features do they need?
- Would they pay for it?

Then improve the product.

Step 7: Build a Team

A startup doesn't always need a large team.

For a software startup, you may need:

- Founder / Product Manager
- Frontend Developer
- Backend Developer
- UI/UX Designer
- AI/ML Engineer
- Marketing/Sales

Initially, one person can perform multiple roles.

Step 8: Launch

Launch your product to your target market.

Possible channels:

- Website

- Facebook
 - LinkedIn
 - University partnerships
 - Direct sales
 - Digital marketing
 - Startup competitions
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Step 9: Measure Growth

Track metrics such as:

- Number of users
 - Active users
 - Customer acquisition
 - Revenue
 - Customer retention
 - Conversion rate
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Step 10: Scale

Once your product works in one market, expand.

For example:

1 university → 10 universities → 100 universities → international market

Startups Already Running in the Market

Here are some well-known examples.

1. Airbnb

Problem: Finding accommodation while traveling.

Solution: Platform connecting travelers with property hosts.

Business model: Commission from bookings.

2. Uber

Problem: Finding convenient transportation.

Solution: App connecting passengers with drivers.

Business model: Commission from rides.

3. Foodpanda

Problem: Ordering food conveniently.

Solution: Online platform connecting customers, restaurants, and delivery riders.

Business model: Delivery fees, commissions, and other commercial partnerships.

4. bKash

Problem: Access to convenient digital financial services.

Solution: Mobile financial services for sending money, payments, and other transactions.

Business model: Transaction and service-based revenue.

5. Pathao

Problem: Transportation, food delivery, and logistics.

Solution: Technology platform offering multiple services.

Business model: Fees and commissions across its services.

6. Canva

Problem: Graphic design can be difficult for non-designers.

Solution: Easy-to-use online design platform.

Business model: Freemium + premium subscriptions.

7. Notion

Problem: People use many separate tools for notes, project management, and documentation.

Solution: All-in-one workspace.

Business model: Freemium + paid plans.

Startup Ideas You Could Consider

Based on your **Software Engineering background**, I would focus on technology-based startups.

Idea 1: AI University Assessment Platform

This is actually one of your strongest ideas.

Problem

Teachers manually:

- Enter marks
- Calculate CLO
- Calculate PLO

- Prepare reports
- Analyze student performance

Solution

Build an AI-powered platform that:

1. Scans answer sheets
2. Detects student information
3. Detects marks
4. Maps questions to CLOs
5. Calculates CLO achievement
6. Calculates PLO achievement
7. Generates reports
8. Provides dashboards

Customers

- Universities
- Teachers
- Departments
- Accreditation teams

Revenue

Subscription:

University → Monthly/Annual SaaS subscription

This idea has a strong **B2B SaaS** potential, but OCR accuracy, privacy, and integration with university systems would need careful handling.

Idea 2: Alumni Engagement Platform

Problem

Universities struggle to maintain active relationships with alumni.

Solution

Create a platform where alumni can:

- Create profiles
- Find classmates
- Find mentors
- Attend events
- Donate
- Post jobs
- Join discussions
- Help current students

Customers

- Universities
- Colleges
- Alumni associations

Revenue

Universities pay annual subscriptions.

You could start with:

One university → One department → Entire university → Other universities

Idea 3: Food Waste Donation Platform

Problem

Restaurants, hotels, events, and supermarkets have excess food while many people need food.

Solution

Platform connecting:

Food Donors → NGOs → Volunteers → Beneficiaries

Features:

- Food listing
- Pickup requests
- Location tracking
- Expiration alerts
- NGO verification
- Donation history

Revenue

Possible models:

- Corporate sponsorship
- NGO partnerships
- CSR funding
- Platform fees for commercial waste management

Idea 4: Student Skill & Internship Platform

Create a platform specifically for Bangladeshi university students.

Students can:

- Create skill profiles
- Upload projects
- Build portfolios
- Find internships
- Take skill assessments
- Find freelance opportunities

Companies can:

- Post internships
- Search student profiles
- Conduct skill tests
- Hire students

Unique Feature

Instead of focusing only on CVs, the platform evaluates:

Projects + GitHub + Skills + Certifications + Assessments

Idea 5: Personal Finance App for Bangladesh

Problem

Many young people don't track their spending properly.

Solution

An app for:

- Income tracking
- Expense tracking
- Budget planning

- Savings goals
- Bill reminders
- Monthly reports

A localized version could support:

- BDT
- bKash
- Nagad
- Bank accounts

My rating: 8/10

Idea 6: Smart University Management SaaS

Build a modular platform for smaller universities and colleges.

Modules:

- Student management
- Teacher management
- Attendance
- Results
- CLO/PLO
- Course registration
- Notices
- Fees
- Reports

Instead of selling a huge system, start with **one module**.

For example:

CLO/PLO Assessment → MVP

Then expand to:

Assessment → Results → Attendance → Student Management

My rating: 9/10

Idea 7: AI-Powered Local Language Learning Platform

Build an AI tutor focused on Bangla-speaking learners.

Students could practice:

- English speaking
- English grammar
- Programming
- Mathematics

The AI could explain difficult concepts in **Bangla + English**.

For example:

Student asks a Python question in Bangla → AI explains in simple Bangla → Gives English technical terms → Provides exercises.

My rating: 8/10

Idea 8: Small Business Digitalization Platform

Many small businesses still manage operations through:

- Paper notebooks
- Excel

- Messenger
- WhatsApp

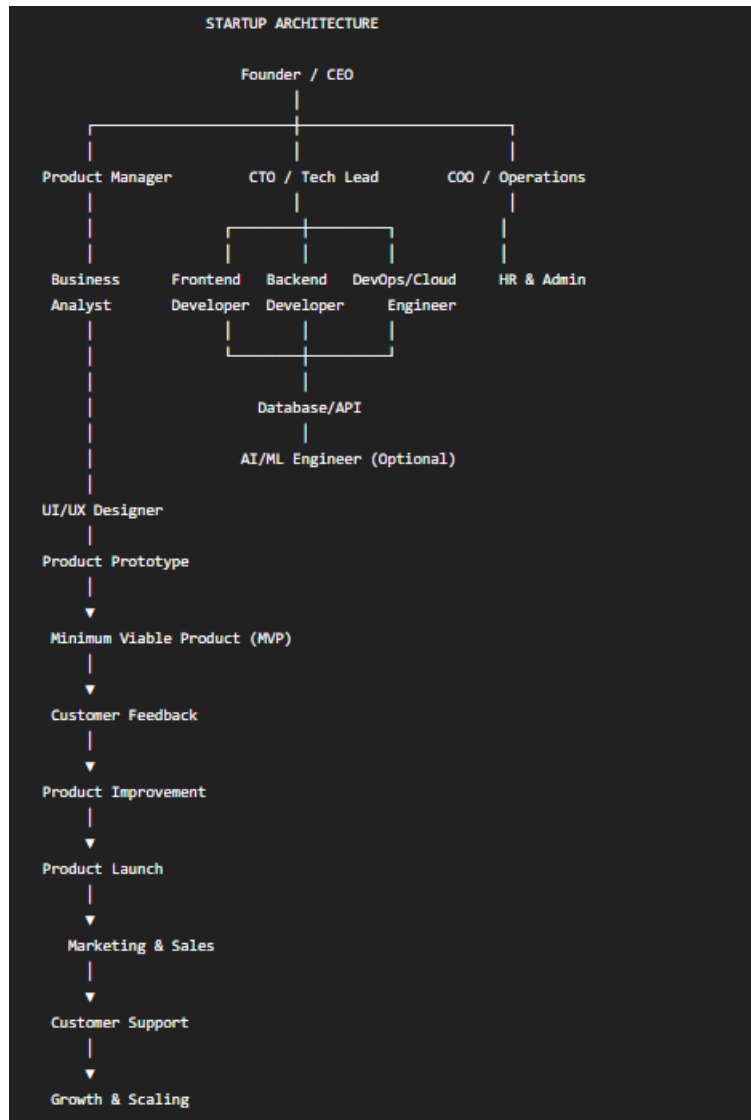
Create an affordable platform for:

- Inventory
- Sales
- Customer records
- Invoices
- Employee management
- Expense tracking
- Reports

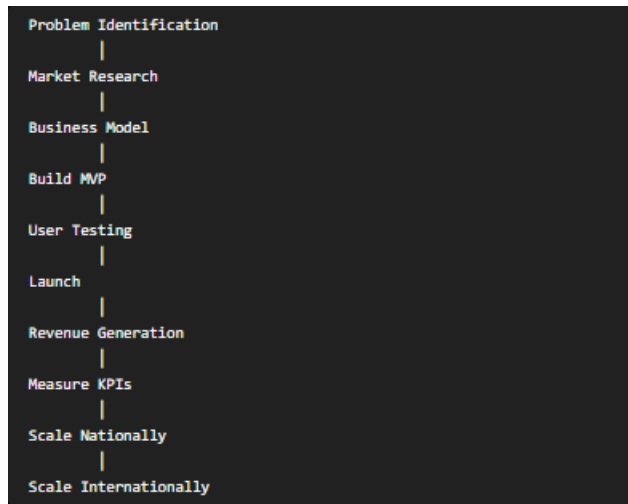
Target:

Small shops → Boutiques → Restaurants → Local businesses

STARTUP ARCHITECTURE



Business Flow



Technical Architecture

